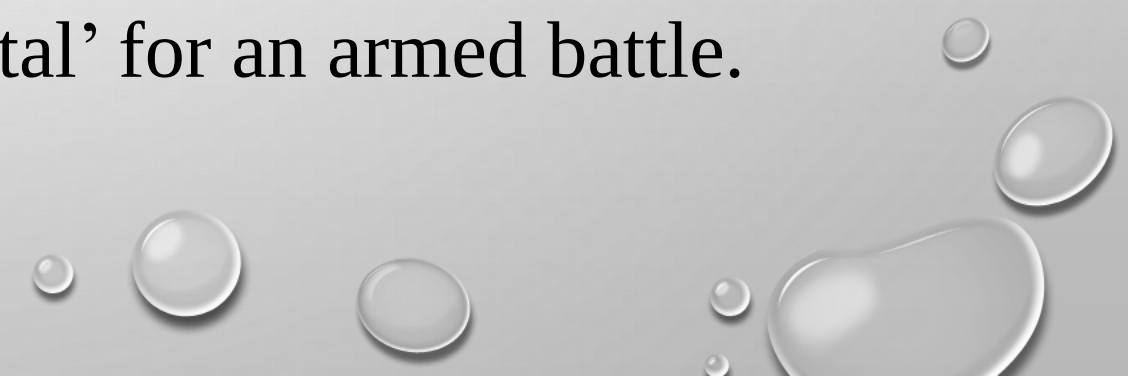


The background of the slide is a light gray gradient. It is decorated with numerous realistic water droplets of various sizes. Some droplets are large and prominent, while others are small and subtle. They are scattered across the frame, with a higher concentration in the top-left and bottom-right corners. The droplets have a glossy, three-dimensional appearance with highlights and shadows.

THE ISLAMIC PERSPECTIVE ON JIHAD & QITAL



• Meaning:

- ‘Jihad’ means to make an utmost effort to achieve some objective. Most this word, in the Quran has been used in sense of struggle while the term ‘Qital’ has been used for war. However, both ‘jihad’ and ‘Qital’ are being used, these days as synonymous terms.
 - The Quran has the specific word ‘Qital’ for an armed battle.
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Basic Principles:

- The first principle that we establish about ‘jihad’ is that it is only the **prerogative of the state**. It is solely the responsibility of the state to announce, manage and control jihad. *Islam rules out any concept of private army*. The whole force has to be under the same command undertaking its duties in a disciplined and united way.
- The second principle is that jihad is deemed valid only when its purpose is **to avert oppression**.
- The third principle is that war is disallowed against the country which has **a peace accord** with the state. Such a country cannot be attacked without a prior declaration about the annulment of the accord even if it is found guilty of oppressing its Muslim resident.
- The fourth principle is that jihad should be declared only when all **material resources are available** in order to materialize the strategy and there are bright prospects of winning the war and sustaining it too.

First Principle

أُذِنَ لِلَّذِينَ يُقَاتَلُونَ بِأَنَّهُمْ ظَلِمُوا وَإِنَّ اللَّهَ عَلَىٰ نَصْرِهِمْ لَقَدِيرٌ الَّذِينَ أُخْرِجُوا مِن دِيَارِهِمْ بِغَيْرِ حَقٍّ إِلَّا أَن يَقُولُوا رَبُّنَا اللَّهُ

- “Permission (to take up arms) is hereby given to those who are attacked, because they have been wronged. Allah has power to grant them victory: those who have been unjustly driven from their homes only because they said: ‘our lord is Allah’. ([Al-Hajj 22:39-40](#))

وَقَاتِلُوا فِي سَبِيلِ اللَّهِ الَّذِينَ يُقَاتِلُونَكُمْ وَلَا تَعْتَدُوا إِنَّ اللَّهَ لَا يُحِبُّ الْمُعْتَدِينَ

- “Fight for the sake of Allah those that fight against you, but do not be aggressive. Allah does not love the aggressors”. ([Al-Baqarah 2:190](#))
- “A Muslim ruler is a shield for Muslims. Qital is just possible under his leadership and this is why people seek his shelter. (It mean that he has to take the final decision in all matters including war and peace)” (Bukhari, 2957)

The Purpose of Jihad:

- The purpose of jihad is to end oppression. It means that war should be declared against any kind of oppression launched by a group or some government and the oppressed ones should be helped.
- The Quran says:

وَمَا لَكُمْ لَا تُقَاتِلُونَ فِي سَبِيلِ اللَّهِ وَالْمُسْتَضْعَفِينَ مِنَ الرِّجَالِ وَالنِّسَاءِ وَالْوِلْدَانِ الَّذِينَ يَقُولُونَ رَبَّنَا أَخْرِجْنَا مِنْ هَذِهِ الْقَرْيَةِ الظَّالِمِ أَهْلُهَا وَاجْعَل لَّنَا مِن لَّدُنكَ وَلِيًّا وَاجْعَل لَّنَا مِن لَّدُنكَ نَصِيرًا

- “And why should you not fight for the cause of Allah, and for the helpless old men, women and children who say: “deliver us, lord, from this city of wrongdoers; send forth to us a guardian from your presence; send to us one that will help us?” ([Al-Nisa 4:75](#))

Jihad And Commitment Of International Treaties:

- Islam has emphasized on this fact a lot that honoring the accords made with other nations is even more important than jihad. It is essential that all such treaties are honored according to their true spirit. The offer of peace from an enemy must be accepted without doubting his sincerity. Not only is this it also not permissible to fight against a nation which has a treaty with you even if it is found guilty of doing wrong with its Muslim residents. The Quran says:

فَإِنْ أَعْتَزَلُوكُمْ فَلَمْ يُقَاتِلُوكُمْ وَأَلْقَوْا إِلَيْكُمُ السَّلَامَ فَمَا جَعَلَ اللَّهُ لَكُمْ عَلَيْهِمْ سَبِيلًا

- “if they (your enemies) keep away from you and cease their hostility and offer you peace, Allah bids you not to harm them”. ([Al-nisa 4:90](#))
- It further says:

وَإِنْ جَنَحُوا لِلسَّلَامِ فَاجْنَحْ لَهَا وَتَوَكَّلْ عَلَى اللَّهِ إِنَّهُ هُوَ السَّمِيعُ الْعَلِيمُ

وَإِنْ يُرِيدُوا أَنْ يَخْدَعُوكَ فَإِنَّ حَسْبَكَ اللَّهُ

- “If they (your enemies) incline to peace, make peace with them, and put your trust in Allah. Surely he is the hearing, the knowing. Should they seek to deceive you, Allah is all-sufficient for you”. ([Al-Anfal 8:61-62](#))

- The commitment to an agreement is so important to god that even the help to the oppressed Muslims is not allowed in its presence. The Quran says:

وَإِنْ أَسْتَنْصَرُوكُمْ فِي الدِّينِ فَعَلَيْكُمْ النَّصْرُ إِلَّا عَلَى قَوْمٍ بَيْنَكُمْ وَبَيْنَهُمْ مِيثَاقٌ وَاللَّهُ بِمَا تَعْمَلُونَ بَصِيرٌ

- “But if they (the Muslims outside your state) seek your help in the cause of your religion, it is your duty to aid them, except against a people you have a treaty with”. ([Al-Anfal 8:72](#))

- It is also essential that Muslims must have such a proportion of manpower as compared to their enemy that they have bright prospects of success.
- The Quran says:

يَا أَيُّهَا النَّبِيُّ حَرِّضِ الْمُؤْمِنِينَ عَلَى الْقِتَالِ ۚ إِنْ يَكُنْ مِنْكُمْ عِشْرُونَ صَابِرُونَ يَغْلِبُوا مِائَتَيْنِ ۚ وَإِنْ يَكُنْ مِنْكُمْ مِائَةٌ يَغْلِبُوا أَلْفًا مِّنَ الَّذِينَ كَفَرُوا بِأَنَّهُمْ قَوْمٌ لَا يَفْقَهُونَ

أَلَنْ خَفَّفَ اللَّهُ عَنْكُمْ وَعَلِمَ أَنَّ فِيكُمْ ضَعْفًا ۚ فَإِنْ يَكُنْ مِنْكُمْ مِائَةٌ صَابِرَةٌ يَغْلِبُوا مِائَتَيْنِ ۚ وَإِنْ يَكُنْ مِنْكُمْ أَلْفٌ يَغْلِبُوا أَلْفَيْنِ بِإِذْنِ اللَّهِ ۚ وَاللَّهُ مَعَ الصَّابِرِينَ

- “Prophet ; rouse the faithful to arms. If there are twenty steadfast men among you, you shall vanquish two hundred; and if there are a hundred, they shall rout a thousand unbelievers, for they are devoid of understanding. Allah has now lightened your burden, for he knows that you are weak. If there are a hundred steadfast men among you, they shall vanquish two hundred; and if there are a thousand, they shall, by Allah's will, defeat two thousand. Allah is with those that are steadfast”. ([Al-Anfal 8:66](#))